

# GOGov Accessibility Audit — Vendor-Level Findings

**Audit scope:** gogovapps.com (homepage) + gogovapps.com/accessibility **Method:** Static HTML analysis via server-rendered DOM capture **Date:** April 18, 2026 **Standard assessed against:** WCAG 2.1 Level AA (DOJ Title II, 28 CFR Part 35) **Deadline context:** April 24, 2026 — six (6) days from audit date — for public entities of 50,000+ residents. Colorado Springs population ~480,000.

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## Executive Summary

The headline finding is not an element-level defect. It is a **policy-level compliance gap in the vendor's own stated commitment**, which directly affects any public entity deploying their software.

1. **GOGov publicly commits to WCAG 2.0 Level AA** — not WCAG 2.1 Level AA, which is the standard adopted by the U.S. Department of Justice under the April 2024 Title II final rule. This gap is stated three times on their Accessibility page and is the exclusive subject of their FAQ.
2. **The Resident Portal VPAT is dated November 2023** — published before the DOJ final rule (April 24, 2024). This VPAT cannot attest conformance to a standard that did not yet exist in regulation at the time of its issuance.
3. **The vendor's own Accessibility page contains WCAG 2.1 AA violations** — including empty alt attributes on all decorative and functional images, placeholder production content, and an accordion component that appears to rely on a non-semantic "+" indicator.

**Implication for the City of Colorado Springs:** The citizen-facing portal at [user.govoutreach.com/coloradospringsco/](https://user.govoutreach.com/coloradospringsco/) (GOGov CRM Resident Portal) is covered only by a VPAT that predates the current legal standard. The vendor has not publicly asserted conformance to WCAG 2.1 AA in any document linked from their accessibility page.

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## Finding 1 — Stated conformance standard is one version behind the legal requirement

**Severity:** Critical (policy-level) **Source:** <https://www.gogovapps.com/accessibility> **Evidence (verbatim from page):**

- | "GOGov is committed to keeping public facing WCAG 2.0 AA accessible solutions"
- | "## WCAG 2.0 AA Compliant Resident facing components"

| "GOGov is committed to keeping public facing accessible solutions."

The Accessibility FAQ on the page consists of six questions, all framed around WCAG 2.0:

- What is WCAG 2.0?
- Why is WCAG 2.0 important?
- What are the key principles of WCAG 2.0?
- How does WCAG 2.0 benefit users with disabilities?
- How does GOGov ensure WCAG 2.0 compliance?
- Why is WCAG 2.0 compliance particularly important for local governments?

**Why this matters:** The DOJ final rule under 28 CFR Part 35 (published April 24, 2024) explicitly adopts **WCAG 2.1 Level AA** as the technical standard for public entity web content and mobile apps. WCAG 2.1 adds 17 new success criteria over 2.0, including several that are material to civic service portals:

| WCAG 2.1 criterion               | Level | What it covers                                                         |
|----------------------------------|-------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1.3.4 Orientation                | AA    | Content not restricted to portrait or landscape only                   |
| 1.3.5 Identify Input Purpose     | AA    | Form fields tagged so browsers/AT can auto-fill (address, phone, etc.) |
| 1.4.10 Reflow                    | AA    | Content reflows at 320 CSS pixels without horizontal scroll            |
| 1.4.11 Non-text Contrast         | AA    | 3:1 contrast for UI components and graphical objects                   |
| 1.4.12 Text Spacing              | AA    | No content loss when users override spacing                            |
| 1.4.13 Content on Hover or Focus | AA    | Dismissible, hoverable, persistent tooltips                            |
| 2.1.4 Character Key Shortcuts    | A     | Single-key shortcuts can be turned off or remapped                     |
| 2.5.1 Pointer Gestures           | A     | Functionality not restricted to multi-point or path-based gestures     |
| 2.5.2 Pointer Cancellation       | A     | Down-event doesn't trigger; users can abort                            |
| 2.5.3 Label in Name              | A     | Accessible name includes visible label text                            |
| 2.5.4 Motion Actuation           | A     | Motion-triggered functions have alternatives                           |
| 4.1.3 Status Messages            | AA    | Status changes announced without focus change                          |

A vendor self-certifying to WCAG 2.0 in April 2026 has, by their own public statement, not certified to the applicable legal standard.

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**Finding 2 — Resident Portal VPAT pre-dates the governing regulation**

**Severity:** Critical (documentation-level) **Source:** <https://www.gogovapps.com/accessibility>

Three VPAT documents are linked:

| Product                          | VPAT date     | Age at audit date |
|----------------------------------|---------------|-------------------|
| GOGov CRM Resident Portal        | November 2023 | 29 months         |
| GOGov Mobile App (iOS & Android) | November 2023 | 29 months         |
| GOGov Permits Portal             | November 2025 | 5 months          |

The Resident Portal is the product that serves `user.govoutreach.com/coloradospringsco/` — the portal where the Accessible Parking form lives.

**The November 2023 VPAT predates the DOJ Title II final rule (April 24, 2024).** It cannot assert conformance to a regulation that did not yet exist. The vendor has not publicly published a refreshed Resident Portal VPAT under WCAG 2.1 AA at any point in the 24 months since the rule was finalized.

**Recommended procurement action:** Formally request the vendor's most current Resident Portal VPAT, audited against WCAG 2.1 AA, per the Revised Section 508 VPAT template (WCAG edition). If one cannot be produced, document that request and the response. Under the DOJ rule, public entities remain responsible for compliance regardless of vendor certification status.

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**Finding 3 — Homepage: Systemic empty alt text**

**Severity:** High **Source:** <https://www.gogovapps.com/> **WCAG criterion:** 1.1.1 Non-text Content (Level A)

Every image rendered on the homepage has an empty or missing `alt` attribute. The pattern in source is `` in the rendered markdown, which corresponds to `` or `` with no `alt` in HTML.

This pattern is confirmed for:

| Image category                                            | Approx count              | Purpose                                         |
|-----------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|
| Navigation icons (call, mail, support center)             | 6+                        | Functional (identify link purpose)              |
| Product menu icons (CRM, Code, Notify, Permit, Mobile)    | 10+                       | Functional (identify nav destination)           |
| Department icons (Administrative, Building, Clerks, etc.) | 16+                       | Functional (identify nav destination)           |
| Product thumbnail images                                  | 4                         | Functional (contextual to product descriptions) |
| Customer logo carousel                                    | 68 (17 logos × 4 repeats) | Decorative, but represent real organizations    |
| Chevron indicators (down, right)                          | 50+                       | Decorative                                      |
| Menu/cancel (hamburger) icons                             | 2                         | Functional (open/close menu)                    |
| Social icons (Facebook, LinkedIn, X)                      | 3                         | Functional (identify link destination)          |
| Blog hero images                                          | 3                         | Contextual                                      |
| Product hero image                                        | 1                         | Contextual                                      |

**Screen reader impact:** A blind user navigating by the Tab key will hear "graphic, link" or simply "link" repeatedly with no indication of what the link leads to. The primary product navigation — the single most important element for a prospective buyer — is unusable.

#### Fix guidance:

- Functional images (icons that ARE the link): provide `alt="Citizen Requests"`, `alt="Phone: (925) 456-4468"`, etc.
- Decorative images (chevrons, curly-quote marks): `alt=""` is correct, but `role="presentation"` or CSS background-image is preferable.
- Customer logos: `alt="City of [Name]"` identifying the municipality. "Decorative" is not a defensible claim when the section is captioned "HUNDREDS OF AGENCIES TRUST GOGOV" — the logos are the evidence.

## Finding 4 — Homepage: Placeholder content in statistics section

**Severity:** High (content quality + accessibility) **Source:** <https://www.gogovapps.com/> **WCAG criterion:** 1.3.1 Info and Relationships (Level A), 2.4.6 Headings and Labels (Level AA)

Under the heading "Local Goverment Powered by GOGov" (note spelling), four statistics are rendered as level-3 headings with placeholder text:

```
### text
Issues Resolved

### text
Citizens Engaged

### text
Violations Resolved

### text
Letters Sent
```

**Screen reader impact:** A user navigating by headings will hear "heading level 3, text" four times in succession, with the meaningful labels ("Issues Resolved," etc.) demoted to body text. The numeric content that was supposed to fill these was never inserted.

**Note:** The parent heading itself contains a spelling error ("Goverment" missing a second "n"), which compounds the quality issue.

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## Finding 5 — Homepage and /accessibility: Placeholder contact info in mobile navigation

**Severity:** High (content integrity) **Source:** <https://www.gogovapps.com/> and <https://www.gogovapps.com/accessibility>

In the mobile navigation, the following contact information is rendered on production:

```
567-345-1234    → href="#" (dead link)
gogov@gmail.com → mailto:gogov@gmail.com
Support center  → href="#" (dead link)
```

The real contact information (925) 456-4468 and [Sales@gogovapps.com](mailto:Sales@gogovapps.com) appears in the desktop header but is not carried through to the mobile navigation. A mobile user attempting to call

support will reach a placeholder phone number. The "Support center" link on mobile is non-functional (`href="#"`).

**Accessibility implication beyond content integrity:** `href="#"` is a keyboard-focusable link that leads nowhere, violating WCAG 2.4.4 Link Purpose and 4.1.2 Name, Role, Value.

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## Finding 6 — Homepage and sitewide: Outdated copyright

**Severity:** Low (content integrity, procurement trust) **Source:** Footer on every page

| "© 2024 GOGov All rights reserved."

In April 2026. Minor on its own but indicative of maintenance cadence.

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## Finding 7 — Sitewide: Spelling and content errors

**Severity:** Low to Medium **Source:** Multiple pages

| Location                                              | Issue                                                                                                    |
|-------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Homepage, department nav                              | "Facilites" — should be "Facilities"                                                                     |
| Homepage, stats heading                               | "Local Goverment" — should be "Government"                                                               |
| Homepage and mobile nav, Code Enforcement description | "Leverage cutting-edge tools to handle to handle more cases in less time" — "to handle" duplicated       |
| Accessibility page title                              | "Accessibility and Compliant Resident Facing Solutions" — non-parallel adjective/participle construction |

These are not directly WCAG failures, but are relevant for WCAG 3.1 (Readable) best practices and, more importantly, for the professional-services credibility of a vendor whose public-sector clients are subject to a legal accessibility regime.

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## Finding 8 — Accessibility page: Exposed "opens in a new tab" text

**Severity:** Medium **Source:** <https://www.gogovapps.com/accessibility> **WCAG criterion:** 1.3.1 Info and Relationships (Level A) **Evidence (verbatim):**

| "Accessibility' as it relates to the Americans With Disabilities Act(opens in a new tab), refers to providing equal access to individuals with disabilities."

The phrase "(opens in a new tab)" is visible inline text rather than a screen-reader-only announcement. This is a common pattern of a visually-hidden class being omitted or overridden, causing accessibility metadata to render as visible content. It also disrupts sentence flow for all users.

**Fix guidance:** Use `class="sr-only"` or `aria-label` on the parent link rather than inline visible text. Better yet, rely on the screen reader's default behavior for `target="_blank"` links combined with a visual icon.

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## Finding 9 — Accessibility page: FAQ accordion indicator appears non-semantic

**Severity:** High (needs verification with rendered page) **Source:**

<https://www.gogovapps.com/accessibility> **WCAG criteria:** 4.1.2 Name, Role, Value (Level A); 1.3.1 Info and Relationships (Level A)

The six FAQ questions render as:

```
#### **What is WCAG 2.0?**  
+  
WCAG 2.0 stands for...
```

The "+" appears to be the only visible indicator of expand/collapse state. Based on the server-rendered HTML, there is no evidence of `<button>` elements with `aria-expanded` attributes. If confirmed on the rendered page, this violates:

- **4.1.2 Name, Role, Value:** a disclosure widget must expose its role and state to assistive technology.
- **1.3.1 Info and Relationships:** the relationship between question and answer must be programmatically determinable.

**Verification needed:** This finding requires inspecting the rendered page's DOM with DevTools open to confirm the actual markup. The static fetch shows text only; it cannot confirm whether the `⊕` is accompanied by proper ARIA attributes.

**Irony for the audit record:** This is an accordion on the page titled "Accessibility."

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## Finding 10 — Accessibility page: Testimonial photos have no alt text

**Severity:** Medium **Source:** <https://www.gogovapps.com/accessibility> **WCAG criterion:** 1.1.1 Non-text Content (Level A)

Four testimonial images of real, named individuals render with empty alt attributes:

- Frankie Rios (City of Santa Clarita, CA)
- Erik Hopwood (City of Oregon City, OR)
- Lorena Ritchey (City of Palm Desert, CA)
- Kim Pickett (Town of Benson, NC)

**Fix guidance:** `alt="Frankie Rios, City of Santa Clarita"` — or a decorative `alt=""` combined with adjacent text that names the person is acceptable, but the current pattern (named individual, photo, no alt) is the worst of both.

This is a dignity concern in addition to a technical one. Named individuals who agreed to appear in a vendor's marketing should be announced by name to screen reader users.

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## Finding 11 — Accessibility page: Unsupported statistic

**Severity:** Low (content credibility) **Source:** <https://www.gogovapps.com/accessibility> **Evidence (verbatim):**

"Approximately 18.7% of the U.S. population have some type of disability that impairs their online access."

No source citation. The figure does not match the CDC's commonly cited ~27% ("up to 1 in 4 U.S. adults have some type of disability"). The precision of "18.7%" implies a specific source that is not linked or named.

Not a WCAG failure, but relevant for the credibility of a page whose purpose is to establish vendor authority on accessibility.

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## Finding 12 — Icon file encoding artifacts

**Severity:** Low (developer hygiene) **Source:** Accessibility page

The curly-quote SVG is loaded from a URL containing `Icon__Curly%2520quotes.svg.svg`. The `%2520` is double-URL-encoding (`%25` is itself an encoded `%`), so `%2520` decodes to `%20`, which should have been the literal space). This indicates the filename was encoded twice during upload.

Not an accessibility issue directly, but a symptom of quality-control gaps in asset management.

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## Audit Scope Limitations

This audit was performed against the server-rendered HTML captured via a simple HTTP fetch (no JavaScript execution, no CSS computation). The following categories of WCAG criteria **cannot be assessed** from static HTML alone and require a rendered-page audit with developer tools:

- **Color contrast** (1.4.3, 1.4.11): requires computed CSS values
- **Focus indicators** (2.4.7): requires keyboard interaction
- **Focus order** (2.4.3): requires Tab-key traversal of rendered DOM
- **Reflow** (1.4.10): requires viewport resizing
- **Text spacing** (1.4.12): requires CSS override testing
- **Content on hover/focus** (1.4.13): requires interactive testing
- **Status messages** (4.1.3): requires observation of ARIA live regions during state changes
- **Keyboard traps** (2.1.2): requires keyboard interaction
- **Target size** (2.5.5): requires computed element dimensions

Findings 3-12 above are those confirmable from static source. A full WCAG 2.1 AA audit of this vendor would require additional testing with axe DevTools, manual keyboard traversal, and NVDA/VoiceOver screen reader verification.

**This report therefore represents a floor, not a ceiling, of the accessibility issues present on the audited pages.**

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## Procurement Documentation Recommendations

For the City of Colorado Springs record, the following is defensible to include in an accessibility-compliance file for this vendor:

1. **The vendor publicly commits to WCAG 2.0 AA, not WCAG 2.1 AA.** Cite the three verbatim statements from <https://www.gogovapps.com/accessibility> captured above.
2. **The applicable Resident Portal VPAT is dated November 2023**, preceding the DOJ final rule of April 24, 2024. Cite the PDF URL.
3. **A formal written request to the vendor for a WCAG 2.1 AA Resident Portal VPAT** should be sent and logged, with any response documented.
4. **The vendor's own Accessibility page demonstrates WCAG 2.1 AA violations** in its homepage and on the Accessibility page itself, as documented in Findings 3-12. This is relevant to assessing the plausibility of the vendor's self-asserted conformance.

5. **The city should retain an independent accessibility auditor** to assess the Resident Portal under WCAG 2.1 AA. The DOJ rule holds the public entity responsible for compliance regardless of vendor certification status (28 CFR 35.105).
  6. **Pending the above**, the city should document remediation efforts on the city-controlled surface (the `user.govoutreach.com/coloradospringsco/` subdomain content) to establish a good-faith compliance record.
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## Appendix A — Sources captured

- <https://www.gogovapps.com/> (retrieved April 18, 2026)
- <https://www.gogovapps.com/accessibility> (retrieved April 18, 2026)
- [https://cdn.prod.website-files.com/6537d400563c932e8c2a42e8/66033759b23b3eff984fdb4c4\\_GOGov%20VPAT%20-%20CRM%20Web%20Portal%20\(2023%20Nov\).pdf](https://cdn.prod.website-files.com/6537d400563c932e8c2a42e8/66033759b23b3eff984fdb4c4_GOGov%20VPAT%20-%20CRM%20Web%20Portal%20(2023%20Nov).pdf) (linked VPAT, not retrieved)
- [https://cdn.prod.website-files.com/6537d400563c932e8c2a42e8/6603379964865043335562ba\\_GOGov%20VPAT%20-%20Mobile%20App%20iOS%20%26%20Android%20\(2023%20Nov\).pdf](https://cdn.prod.website-files.com/6537d400563c932e8c2a42e8/6603379964865043335562ba_GOGov%20VPAT%20-%20Mobile%20App%20iOS%20%26%20Android%20(2023%20Nov).pdf) (linked VPAT, not retrieved)
- [https://cdn.prod.website-files.com/6537d400563c932e8c2a42e8/693719ba872bf2bea3d328b6\\_GOGov%20VPAT%20-%20Permits%20Web%20Portal%20\(2025%20Nov\).pdf](https://cdn.prod.website-files.com/6537d400563c932e8c2a42e8/693719ba872bf2bea3d328b6_GOGov%20VPAT%20-%20Permits%20Web%20Portal%20(2025%20Nov).pdf) (linked VPAT, not retrieved)

## Appendix B — Regulatory citations

- 28 CFR Part 35 (Title II of the ADA) — DOJ final rule, "Nondiscrimination on the Basis of Disability; Accessibility of Web Information and Services of State and Local Government Entities," 89 FR 31320, April 24, 2024.
- WCAG 2.1 Level AA — W3C Recommendation, June 5, 2018. Incorporated by reference in 28 CFR 35.200.
- Colorado HB 21-1110 — Colorado Laws for Persons with Disabilities, enforcement effective July 1, 2024, \$3,500 per violation.